

Weapons and computing

Lockheed Martin, the arms manufacturer is set to become the world's first company to use quantum computing as part of its business



BlackBerry CEO dreams big

Ten years down the line BB CEO Thorsten Heins hopes to replace tablets and laptops with phones as primary computing devices

Agent 001



ASRock Z77 OC Formula

We visited two different shops and it came as no surprise that both the shopkeepers quoted exorbitant prices for most of the components (there will be many who will try to fleece you). So we decided to continue our search elsewhere. Thankfully, the stores we visited later quoted normal prices. I took my brother and my friend to one of the shops from where I bought my gaming mouse and keyboard as I knew him well and so that we might get a good deal. I showed the vendor the configuration required by my friend and he gave us two options for the motherboard - the ASUS Maximus V formula and the **ASRock Z77 OC Formula**. So we selected the latter as it was cheaper than the ASUS board by at least ₹3,000 and also purchased the other components shown in the table alongside. Yeah the total figure is mind-boggling and it left me and my brother looking at each other in shock and awe and, we're not too proud to admit, quite a bit of jealousy, as my friend, who couldn't control his happiness, had started jumping up and down

in the shop while the payment was being made to the happy vendor. The type of configuration was just what he needed; it turned out to be an extremely powerful rig which would be a breeze to overclock.

When you look at the individual choices, you can see that the **Asus NVIDIA GTX660 TI-DC2-2GD5 2 GB** graphics card was chosen because it runs very cool, given the excellent cooling system. Another good

card would be the **MSI N660Ti PE 2GD5/OC** for ₹21,000, which runs almost as cool (due to the so called, TwinFroze system). The RAM modules were selected keeping in mind that they run at 2133MHz which is great but they do have high latencies. For CPU cooling, we bought the **Corsair H100i** as it was among the newer and higher performing all-in-one liquid coolers in the market. As for the PSU, we went with the CM Silent Pro M850 mainly because of the efficiency, stability and price. The other components were my friend's choices, which turned out to be surprisingly good.

My job was half done as my brother still had to buy a cooler for himself and I wanted to get a new motherboard as well as a cooler for my overclocking needs. We

saw a bunch of air coolers, among them was the **Cooler Master X6**. It retailed for about ₹3,500 and was a decent performer but then my brother spotted a liquid cooler from the same brand (the **CM Seidon 120M**) which, though it was listed at ₹5,999, can be had for around ₹4,600 and is an excellent performer at the price. It was my turn now and I had zeroed in on the **MSI Z77 Big Bang MPower** motherboard at ₹15,000 which is supposed to be good for overclocking. My older board was very basic and not really meant for overclocking my Intel Core i5 3570k. Besides that, I searched for a liquid cooler which was not only a decent performer but also not too hard on my wallet. I ended up purchasing the

Component	Brand and Model	Price
Processor	Intel Core i7 3770K	20,875
Motherboard	ASRock Z77 OC Formula	17,500
RAM	G.Skill RipjawsX 8 GB (2 x 4 GB) (F3-17000CL11D-8GBXL) 2133 MHz	5,000
Graphics Card	Asus NVIDIA GTX660 TI-DC2-2GD5 2 GB	21,500
HDD	WD WD20EZRX 2TB	5,600
SSD	Corsair Neutron 120 GB	7,749
CPU Cooler	Corsair H100i	8,700
PSU	Cooler Master Silent Pro M850 - 850 watts	10,600
Cabinet	Cooler Master Storm Trooper	11,800
Total		1,09,324

Corsair H80 for ₹6,500 and returned home with a sense of elation and anticipation. My wallet was quite a bit lighter, but but these components, coupled with a Titan that I had somehow managed to "borrow" from a friend, I had an overclockable beast that would show those upstarts how its done. Vengeance shall be mine. Mwahaha!

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